Follow a load to the ground

Task 2.2 / Prepare and draw

Name _____ Team _____ Date _____

01 Set up the investigation

Example building: apartments over a shop. Start at a person upstairs. Show how a floor, beam, column or wall, and foundation transfer the load to the ground.

Count a model deck’s self-weight as a permanent load. Mark where you will add equal test masses.

Strip span	Strip self-weight or description	Added mass	Support layout
Fixed setup			

02 Plan it on paper

Draw arrows from one person or object through floor, beam, support, and foundation.

My prediction, chosen feature or design limit

Follow a load to the ground

Task 2.2 / Test, compare and explain

Name _____ Team _____ Date _____

03 Run the test and record what happened

Span two low supports with the strip. Add a light load first at the center, then near one support. Keep the span fixed. Record the change in bend at both positions. Separate the added live load from the model's own weight.

Load position	Reference height	Loaded height	Bend and units
No added load			
Center			
Near support			

04 Use the reading

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Complete the assigned checks in the interactive reader. Here, identify a page and one idea that helps explain your result or design decision.

05 Individual explanation

Trace one load on your building sketch to the ground. Which part carries it next, and why?

Keep these sheets with the work. Save the individual explanation in the lesson's Explain step.